

ORION TECHNOLOGIES

Employee Operations & Benefits Handbook

Internal Knowledge Base • Version 3.2 • September 2026

This handbook contains policies, procedures, benefits, department responsibilities, and frequently referenced operational information for Orion Technologies employees.

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Important: This is a synthetic document created for testing document-retrieval and RAG systems. It is not a real company policy document.

1. Company Overview

Orion Technologies is a fictional software company headquartered in Bengaluru, India. The company develops cloud platforms, business automation software, and artificial-intelligence products for small and medium-sized businesses.

The company is organized into six primary departments: Engineering, Product, Sales, Customer Success, People Operations, and Finance. Engineering owns application development and infrastructure, while Product defines product requirements and maintains the product roadmap.

The People Operations department manages employee records, leave administration, onboarding, benefits, training coordination, and workplace policies. Questions about payroll should be directed to Finance, while questions about leave balances should be directed to People Operations.

2. Working Hours and Attendance

Standard working hours are Monday through Friday, from 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM. Employees receive a one-hour lunch break between 1:00 PM and 2:30 PM. Teams may agree on a different lunch time as long as customer coverage and project requirements are maintained.

Employees are expected to maintain at least 40 working hours per week. Engineering employees assigned to production support may have scheduled shifts outside the standard hours. Shift schedules are published by the Engineering Operations team at least seven days in advance.

An employee who expects to arrive more than 30 minutes late should inform their manager before the start of the working day. Repeated unexplained attendance issues are reviewed by the employee's manager and People Operations.

3. Remote and Hybrid Work

Orion uses a hybrid work model. Employees may work remotely up to three days per week when their role and team responsibilities permit it. Each department may designate specific collaboration days when employees are expected to work from the office.

The Engineering department's standard collaboration days are Tuesday and Thursday. Engineering employees may choose a third office day depending on project requirements. New employees in their first 30 calendar days are expected to work from the office unless their manager approves an exception.

Remote employees must maintain a reliable internet connection, use the company-approved VPN when accessing internal systems, and remain reachable through the official communication platform during working hours.

Remote work is not automatically permitted for employees who handle restricted customer information. Such employees require written approval from their department head and the Information Security team.

4. Annual Leave Policy

Full-time employees receive 24 days of annual paid leave per calendar year. Leave is credited monthly at the rate of 2 days per completed month of employment. Employees joining during the year receive a prorated allocation for their first calendar year.

Employees should normally submit annual leave requests at least five working days before the first day of leave. Managers are responsible for balancing employee leave requests with project and customer requirements.

Unused annual leave may be carried into the following calendar year up to a maximum balance of 12 days. Any balance above 12 days expires at the end of the year unless People Operations grants an exception.

Employees who need more than five consecutive working days of annual leave should discuss the dates with their manager before submitting the request.

5. Sick Leave and Medical Absence

Employees receive 10 days of paid sick leave per calendar year. Sick leave is intended for illness, medical appointments, recovery, and related health needs.

If an employee is absent for more than three consecutive working days, People Operations may request supporting medical documentation in accordance with applicable company procedures.

Sick leave does not automatically convert into annual leave when the employee has exhausted the sick-leave balance. Extended medical absence is handled separately by People Operations.

6. Parental and Family Leave

Eligible employees may apply for parental leave through People Operations. The duration and eligibility requirements depend on the applicable employment category and current company policy.

Employees should notify their manager and People Operations as early as reasonably possible when planning family leave so that project responsibilities can be reassigned.

Family emergency leave may be approved for urgent situations involving an immediate family member. The employee's manager records the approved absence through the HR portal.

7. Employee Benefits

Orion provides eligible full-time employees with medical insurance, accidental-coverage insurance, and an annual learning allowance. Benefit eligibility begins after the employee completes the applicable onboarding requirements.

The annual learning allowance is INR 30,000 per employee. It may be used for approved technical courses, professional certifications, conferences, and books. Hardware purchases are not covered by the learning allowance.

Employees must submit learning-expense claims within 30 days of the purchase date. Claims require a valid invoice and proof of payment. The Finance team normally processes approved claims within 10 business days.

8. Internship Program

Orion's Technology Internship Program is managed jointly by People Operations and the Engineering Internship Committee. The standard internship duration is 12 weeks.

Interns are assigned a technical mentor during their first week. The mentor is responsible for defining the initial project scope, reviewing weekly progress, and providing technical feedback.

Interns receive a laptop, development-environment access, and an internal documentation account. Access to production customer data is not provided by default.

At the end of the internship, the mentor submits a project evaluation covering technical implementation, documentation, communication, testing practices, and ability to work with feedback.

9. Engineering Development Standards

All production code must be reviewed through a pull request before merging into the main branch. At least one approved reviewer is required for standard changes. Changes affecting authentication, authorization, payments, or customer-data handling require two reviewers.

Python services should follow the team's formatting and linting configuration. API endpoints must validate incoming data and return structured error responses.

Automated tests are required for new business logic. A change that modifies an existing behavior should include a regression test unless the reviewer documents why a test is impractical.

Production credentials must never be committed to source control. Secrets must be stored using the approved secret-management system.

10. AI and Data Handling

AI applications developed at Orion must identify the sources used to ground generated answers when the application is designed for knowledge retrieval. Retrieved documents should retain source metadata such as document identifier, page number, and section.

Customer data must not be copied into personal AI tools or unapproved external services. Synthetic or anonymized data should be used for experiments whenever real customer data is not required.

When a RAG application cannot find sufficient evidence in its authorized knowledge base, the application should clearly indicate that the information was not found rather than presenting an unsupported answer as fact.

Engineering teams must document access-control rules for internal knowledge bases. Authentication verifies a user's identity; authorization determines which documents or operations that user may access.

11. Information Security

Employees must use multi-factor authentication for company accounts. Passwords must not be shared with colleagues, managers, vendors, or support personnel.

A suspected security incident should be reported to the Security Operations team as soon as possible. Examples include accidentally exposing credentials, receiving a suspicious attachment, losing a company device, or discovering unauthorized access to an internal system.

Company laptops must use disk encryption and automatic screen locking. Employees working remotely should avoid using unknown public computers to access internal systems.

12. Expense Reimbursement

Business expenses require manager approval unless the expense falls under an approved recurring budget. Employees should submit expense claims through the Finance portal.

Travel expenses may include approved transportation, accommodation, and meals within the limits defined by the employee's travel category. Personal entertainment expenses are not reimbursable.

Expense claims should normally be submitted within 30 days. Claims submitted later may require additional approval from the employee's department head.

13. Performance Reviews

Employees participate in a formal performance review twice per year. The review cycle runs from January through June and from July through December.

Performance discussions consider delivery of agreed objectives, quality of work, collaboration, communication, technical or functional growth, and adherence to company practices.

Managers should provide regular feedback throughout the review period rather than waiting until the formal review.

14. Internal Support Contacts

People Operations handles leave, benefits, onboarding, employment records, and workplace-policy questions.

Finance handles salary, reimbursements, expense claims, and financial documentation.

IT Support handles laptop issues, account access, VPN problems, and approved software installation.

Security Operations handles suspected security incidents, credential exposure, phishing reports, and access-control concerns.

Engineering Operations handles production-support schedules, engineering infrastructure coordination, and deployment procedures.

15. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: How many annual paid leaves does a full-time employee receive?

A: 24 days per calendar year, credited at 2 days per completed month.

Q: How many sick-leave days are provided?

A: 10 paid sick-leave days per calendar year.

Q: How many days per week can an eligible employee normally work remotely?

A: Up to three days per week, subject to team and role requirements.

Q: What are the standard Engineering collaboration days?

A: Tuesday and Thursday.

Q: What is the annual learning allowance?

A: INR 30,000 per eligible full-time employee.

Q: How long is the standard technology internship?

A: 12 weeks.

Q: How many reviewers are required for a normal production-code change?

A: At least one approved reviewer. Authentication, authorization, payment, and customer-data changes require two.

Q: What should a RAG application do when it cannot find evidence?

A: It should state that the information was not found in its authorized knowledge base rather than inventing an answer.

16. Retrieval Test Scenarios

Direct fact: What is the annual learning allowance?

Cross-section fact: Which department handles leave requests, and how many annual-leave days does a full-time employee receive?

Exact-match query: What are the Engineering collaboration days?

Multi-hop query: An Engineering employee is in their first 30 days. Can they normally work remotely three days per week?

Policy query: What happens to annual leave above the 12-day carry-forward limit?

Security query: What is the difference between authentication and authorization in the AI/data policy?

Procedure query: How many reviewers are needed for a change affecting customer data?

Negative query: What is Orion's policy for stock-market trading by employees?

Citation query: Which page/section contains the internship duration and mentor responsibilities?

Combination query: Who handles expense claims, and how long do employees normally have to submit them?

End of synthetic knowledge base • ORN-HR-2026-03